



ECFA League Handbook

2026/27 season | Rules, procedures and manager guidance

<https://ecfa.leaguerepublic.com/index.html>

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1 - Last Updated

Last updated: 23 July 2026

2 - Disciplinary Procedure/Conduct of Spectators (League & Cup) & Appeal Process

General Information

Disciplinary thresholds remain unchanged from the previous season and apply to both league and cup competitions.

Points System

- Yellow Card - 2 points
- Red Card - 4 points

Note: Two yellow cards in a single match, resulting in a red card, count as 4 points in total.

Suspension Deferrals

- If a player reaches a disciplinary threshold that would cause them to miss a cup final due to an earlier caution, the suspension will be deferred.
- However, if a player receives a red card for violent conduct or serious foul play, the suspension will stand, and the player will be ineligible for the final.

Disciplinary Thresholds

Threshold	Points	Suspension
1	10 points	1-match suspension (plus any red card suspension)
2	18 points	3-match suspension (plus any red card suspension)
3	24 points	5-match suspension (plus any red card suspension)
4	28 points	7-match suspension (plus any red card suspension)
5	30 points	10-match suspension (plus any red card suspension)

Serious Offences

- Foul and Abusive Language (towards opponent):
3-match ban
- **Foul and Abusive Language (towards an official):**
 - 0 1st Offence: 5-match ban
 - 0 2nd Offence: 1-year ban (to be reviewed before eligibility to return)
- **Discriminatory Language:**
 - 0 1st Offence: 10-match ban
 - 0 2nd Offence: 1-year ban (to be reviewed before eligibility to return)
- **Violent Conduct (e.g. kicking, punching):**
 - 0 Minimum 1 year ban.
 - 0 Review required before returning
 - 0 Repeat Offence: Lifetime ban

Note: All red card offences will be assessed individually. Disciplinary records from previous seasons will be considered, and repeat offenders may face extended bans or expulsion from the league for persistent poor conduct.

Team Disciplinary Penalties

- 20+ disciplinary points across 4 consecutive matches: Mike Egan (Or) Linesmen for 3 matches, at a cost to the team under disciplinary review.
- Most teams remain well below these limits. Maintaining good conduct while playing competitively is achievable and encouraged.

Appeals Process

- Only lifetime bans may be appealed.
- Appeals must be submitted by the team manager, with supporting evidence of improved behaviour (e.g., discipline records from other leagues).

- The league may request additional information and may consult with relevant church representatives, not just the team manager.

Behaviour Expectations

All players, managers, coaches, and spectators are expected to uphold the values and ethos of the Church League at all times - during league matches, cup games, friendlies, and social events.

If any individual is found using obscene or intimidating language, or behaving disruptively to the point a referee must abandon a match, the league (in consultation with the lead referee) may:

- Order a replay on neutral ground, or
- Award a win to the opposing team

Further disciplinary action may also be taken.

Playing / Attending Matches While Banned in ECFA League

If a player under suspension in the ECFA League plays:

- Their ban will be doubled automatically
 - The match result will be overturned to a 3-0 loss for the offending team
 - If the team already lost, the opposition can choose between keeping the result or receiving a 3-0 awarded win
- If a player attends a game and is serving a serious ban (four or more games);
- The team may receive a one-point deduction from their league total
 - Their ban will be doubled automatically

The onus is on the manager of each team to communicate all of the above when discussing bans with players, teams.

3 - ECFA Honours

On league website.

4 - Previous League Season & Top Scorers

5 - Club Contact Details

Barclay Viewforth Church FC - Dean McBride - 07 941 026 310
 Carrubbers Church FC - Allister Torrence - 07 710 964 900
 Gorgie United Salvation Army FC - Ian Midwinter - 07 949 742 115
 Kirkliston Community Church FC - Iain McCalman - 07 722 138 933
 Ladywell Baptist Church FC - Douglas Benson - 07 539 258 439
 Liberton Church FC - Elliot Edmunds - 07 490 769 571
 Murrayburn Church FC - Craig Mitchell - 07 598 952 547
 North Berwick Abbey Church FC - Jack Fish - 07 949 377 083
 South East Saints FC - James Milligan - 07 711 793 463
 St Marys Metropolitan Church FC - Brian Murray - 07 860 648 301
 The Mission FC - Andy Constable - 07 739 711 363
 White Lightning Bruntsfield Church FC - Stuart Miller - 07 791 834 570

6 - Referee Contact Details

See Referees Tab on Website.

7 - Referee Notes & Agreement

ECFA League Agreement - 2026/27 Season

This agreement outlines the expectations and terms for referees officiating regularly within the **Edinburgh Churches Football Association (ECFA)** League. It has been reviewed and approved by the ECFA League Committee.

General Referee Responsibilities

- **Match Assignments:**

Committee will assign all fixtures to referees.

- **Pitch Inspections:**

If multiple fixtures are scheduled near your home, you may be requested to carry out a pitch inspection the evening before or morning of the game.

0 A **petrol allowance of £10** will be provided for inspections, payable via **bank transfer**.

- **Match Fees:**

0 **Standard match fee:** £55 per game, to be collected from the **away team**.

0 **Cup matches with extra time/penalties:** Fee remains **£55**, unless otherwise agreed on the day by both teams.

0 **Postponed due to weather:** No fee is payable.

0 **Postponed due to a team not showing up:** Referee may receive **£55**, at the **referee's discretion**.

- **Availability and Communication:**

0 If unable to officiate a scheduled match, notify **the chat immediately**.

0 Referees are primarily assigned to matches within **Edinburgh**, but may occasionally be asked to travel to nearby outskirts.

0 **Midweek matches** may be held outside Edinburgh; you will only be expected to officiate once the venue has been confirmed and agreed upon.

Match Reporting and Conduct

- **Score Reporting:**

0 For **Saturday matches**, the score must be posted in the group chat by **6:00 PM** the same day.

0 For **midweek matches**, the score must be shared by **6:00 PM the following day**.

- **Disciplinary Reporting:**

0 All **yellow and red cards** must be reported **via the group chat**.

0 If necessary, a **written incident report** may be required for serious matters.

- **Match Day Procedures:**

0 Referees will wear a **kit colour different** from both teams, based on pre-match communication.

0 The ECFA does **not use team lines**, so referees are expected to **record player names rather than numbers**.

0 Referees should **monitor substitutions**, recording the **jersey numbers of all players entering the field**.

Substitution and Squad Rules

- **Maximum squad size:** 18 players.

- **Maximum of five substitutions per team** is allowed.

- **Rolling substitutions** are permitted **only if both teams agree** and have informed the referee **prior to kick-off**

0 While the ECFA's default stance is against rolling subs, mutual agreement between both teams overrides this for individual matches.

0 If a team is reduced to 10 men due to injuries, they can **bring on a player** already subbed off, this is regardless of an **agreement of rolling subs** and is an agreement between all managers in the league.

League Ethos and Behaviour

- The ECFA is a **church-led league**. Some teams may choose to **pray before kick-off**

- Teams are expected to uphold the **Christian ethos and values** of the league.

- If a referee has concerns regarding a team's conduct or general behaviour, they are encouraged to **inform the league directly**.

Referee Contact Information

Please complete the following details:

- **Full Name:**

- **Address:**

- **Telephone Number:**

- **Email Address:**

- **First Aid Trained:** Yes / No

8 - League Fees

The fee for each current team is £200 for the season, payable by 9 August 2026.

9 - Competitions & Qualification Criteria

Appin Edinburgh Churches Football Association

Winner of League will be determined on the below criteria

Season due to start 08/08/2026

Points

Goal Difference

Head To Head

Maximum 5 subs

ECFA Kwik Fit Cup**Group stages**

Four Groups

Top 4 Qualify from each group Top v 4th

Points Win Group

Goal Difference If Points are the same

Head to Head if above is the same

Wins in group if all of the above is the same

Goals Scored if all above is the same

Best discipline

Maximum 5 subs

Quarter finals

One Leg

Group Winner at home

Penalties

Rolling subs must be agreed by both teams and referee advised before

Maximum 5 Subs

Semi Finals

One Leg

Penalties

Rolling subs must be agreed by both teams and referee advised before

Maximum 5 Subs

Final

One Leg

Neutral Venue

Penalties

Rolling subs must be agreed by both teams and referee advised before

Maximum 5 Subs

ECFA Knockout Cup**Preliminary Round**

Three Teams receive a bye into the Quarter finals

10 teams play for a place in the quarter finals

One Leg

Rolling subs must be agreed by both teams and referee advised before

Maximum 5 Subs

Penalties

Quarter Finals

One Leg

Rolling subs must be agreed by both teams and referee advised before

Maximum 5 Subs

Penalties

Semi finals

One Leg

Rolling subs must be agreed by both teams and referee advised before
 Maximum 5 Subs
 Penalties

Final

One Leg
 Rolling subs must be agreed by both teams and referee advised before
 Maximum 5 Subs
 Penalties

Knockout Cup

Preliminary Round (30/08/25)		Quarter Final (27/09/25)		Semi Final (25/10/25)		Final (22/11/25)							
SES	Tie A	Winner Tie E	QF 1	Winner QF 3 v Winner QF 2	SF 1	Winner SF 1 v Winner SF 2							
V													
W Light													
Ladywel	Tie B	Winner Tie C	QF 2	Winner QF 1 v Winner QF 4	SF 2								
V													
The Mission													
Port Seton	Tie C	Murrayburn	QF 3										
V													
Hope church													
Kirkliston	Tie D	Gorgie	QF 4										
V													
Barclay													
Carrubbers	Tie E												
V													
St Marys													

10 - Indefinite Ban Procedure

Can only be appealed once, which must occur at least 12 months after the ban was imposed.
 Appeals must be submitted by the team manager, with supporting evidence of improved behaviour (e.g., discipline records from other leagues).
 The league may request additional information and consult with relevant church representatives, not just the team manager.

Disciplinary Thresholds - Returning Players

Threshold	Points	Suspension
1	6 points	1-match suspension
2	10 points	3-match suspension
3	14 points	5-match suspension

Note:

Upon reaching 14 points, the player and the manager / Church Rep will discuss the reasons for the high disciplinary points with the league committee and review the nature of the cards received. This review may lead to the reintroduction of an indefinite ban.

11- Postponement of Matches

All teams are entitled to request one postponement of a game if they are unable to field a squad, however it is the team who is cancelling the matches responsibility to contact the fixture organiser, opposition and referee before Monday the week of the match when a Saturday, and if a midweek match at least 3 working days to stop any additional costs being passed to the team. Cancelled games will be aimed to be played at a later date in the season rather than an automatic walkover being handed to the team who hasn't forfeited that game. If it's an exceptional circumstance and a date for the game to be rescheduled cannot be found, then the team requesting the postponement will forfeit the Tie/Points.

12 - Strip Colours

It is up to the home team to advise of any strip changes to the away team and the referee.

13 - Top Goal Scorers

This will continue to be updated via a text message/WhatsApp to Iain McCalman who will then update the website, please note this will only be required for "League" games and not all competitions.

14 - Rolling Subs

Both teams need to agree prior to kick off if they wish to do rolling subs, if one team does not want to then rolling subs will not take place for that match. If both teams agree to do rolling subs then the home team must inform the referee prior to kick off.

15 - Player Transfer Form & Day off Request

Player Transfer Form



Transfer of Player from one ECFA team to Another.

Transfer of incoming player Directly from ECFA team.

This form should be used if a player has moved from one ECFA team to another directly, example – Chapel to Broxburn

Name of Player	Cameron Mackenzie
Date of Birth	08.05.1984
Previous Team	Ladywell
New Team	Kirkliston
Date Of Transfer	14.08.2022
Competitions played in for previous team	N/A

Transfer of player incoming who has played for an ECFA team in current season.

This form should be filled in if a player has moved from ECFA to amateur and back to ECFA, this should be used even if that play is returning to the same team

Name of Player	
Date of Birth	
Previous Team & Date stopped playing	
New Team	
Date Of Transfer	
Competitions played in for previous team	

Please note that if a player has already moved twice this season between ECFA teams, directly or indirectly then the decision on that transfer will need to be sanctioned by the league committee.

Day off Request

✓



ECFA League

REQUEST FOR DAY OFF

Club: Port Seton

Date Requested: 20/08/2022

Club Official: Ally Donaldson

ECFA

CONFIRMATION OF REQUEST FOR DAY OFF

Date Requested: 08/08/2022

I confirm that the above club has been excused from playing on the above date.

SIGNATURE OF MATCH SECRETARY I. McCalman

DATE 08/08/2022

16 - Resignation / Expulsion from League

Team Withdraws/expelled and Player Movement

If a team withdraws/is expelled from the league, all previously played matches will stand, but all future fixtures will be recorded as 3-0 forfeits in favour of the opposition, effective from the date of the team's withdrawal.

Players from a withdrawn team are free to join other ECFA teams and participate in all competitions, subject to the following conditions:

The April 1st player registration rule remains in effect. Players registering after April 1st will not be eligible for cup matches or designated key league games, regardless of the team's withdrawal.

Suspensions and bans will carry over to the player's new team and commence from the date of their new registration.

Example: If a team folds on March 3rd and a player with a 3-match ban joins a new team on March 20th, the ban will begin on March 20th and apply to the next three matches for that player.

A maximum of Three players from a withdrawn team may join a single team during the same season.

If additional players wish to join a team that has already accepted three players from the withdrawn team, they must wait until the following season to register with that team.

17 - League Trophies

All teams are expected to get the trophy they win engraved and can claim this cost back from the league. All teams must return the trophy in the same state it was handed over or will be liable for the cost of a replacement trophy.

18 - Matchday Summary

Match day Preparation

- Home team books the pitch (Unless Ian Midwinter books this on behalf of the league)
- Home team to contact ref & opposition once pitch is booked and advise of strip colour. This must be done by 6:00 PM on Thursday at the latest.
- All teams to advise Ian Midwinter Close of Play Tuesday if unable to fulfil a fixture, failure to do this will result in a forfeit and a 3-0 loss, and team may need to pay cost of park (if within 48 hours) and referee on the day.
- Teams can request one postponement per season, however must inform Iain McCalman before Monday the week of the match when a Saturday, and if a midweek match at least 3 working days to stop any additional costs being passed to the team.
- Any refs unable to take a game must contact Greg Healey as soon as possible so he can find a replacement.
- Liam Burns advises teams of suspension period.
- Maximum Squad of 18
- Only 5 subs can be used (Regardless of rolling or not), it's up to each team manager to communicate to their squad if they have more than 16 then some players will not get on.
- Both teams must agree rolling subs and confirm with the referee prior to kick off, if one team does not agree, then rolling subs will not happen. Please note, if someone is injured and CANNOT carry on and the squad is down to 10 men they can bring someone on to replace them, the injured player cannot return to the field of play, and this must not be used purely to gain an advantage
- Home team brings nets & match ball
- Home team puts nets up (Temporary rule until the next meeting)
- Home team must pay the referee his fee by 6pm the same day of the game, either by bank transfer, or cash on the day.
- Away team must pay the home team their share (50%) of the fees by Thursday evening 11pm.

Post-Match

- Both teams to send Iain list of scorers from the match (League matches only)
- Home team to send Iain (WhatsApp chat) the matchday score by 2pm the day of the game, 11pm for midweek matches.
- Referee to send any yellow/reds to Greg Healey and result of game into the referee chat.

19 - ECFA Code of Conduct

Edinburgh Churches Football Association is a church led, Christian league that aims to provide an environment where competitive football is played in a manner that reflects Christian values. We welcome players of all backgrounds regardless of faith but expect that those associated with each club are sympathetic to our values and adhere to this code of conduct.

We expect that management teams will attempt to develop a settled squad, build relationships, and foster an environment that will lead to opportunities to witness.

As part of this purpose, we strongly discourage teams from bringing players in from outside of their existing squad without the prior approval of the opposition and league chairman, and we will not permit the use of 'ringers' for any fixture. That is, players deemed to have been brought in to strengthen a team beyond its usual squad resources to increase their chances of winning a fixture or progressing in a competition.

Clubs found to have acted in this manner will be subject to disciplinary proceedings, including the forfeiture of the result or expulsion from competition.

Playing under the banner of Edinburgh Churches Football Association comes with certain expectations and responsibilities which players, management and supporters of each club will be asked to respect and support whilst participating in matches and events this season.

At all times play hard but fair - giving 100% effort, remembering that it's not only the result but also HOW we play that matters.

Team-mates, the opposition and referees must be treated with the utmost respect.

'Simulation' or 'Gamesmanship' is cheating and will not be tolerated in this league. No attempt should be made to wind up or incite a player or mislead a referee.

Control your language, watch what you say! - Foul and abusive language spoils the image of the league, and negative comments affect the spirit within each team.

During a game, only the captain and manager can speak to the referee. Any grievances should be taken to the captain. Always play to the whistle and accept the referees' decision as final.

Those involved on the side-lines are not to get involved in referee's decisions. No abuse should be directed towards anyone involved on either side or the referee.

Exercise Sportsmanship in all situations, gracious in victory and dignified in defeat.

Physical violence will not be tolerated at any level and will result in disciplinary action, up to and including expulsion from the league.

As Manager and Representative of my club, I undertake to try and adhere to behavioural standards that are consistent with the Christian faith and encourage all those associated with my club to follow these practices

20 - League Registration & Criteria (New Applicants)

The Edinburgh Churches Football Association (ECFA) is a church-led, Christian league committed to providing a competitive football environment that reflects Christian values.

We welcome players from all backgrounds, regardless of faith. However, it is expected that all individuals associated with a club are **sympathetic to these values** and agree to abide by the ECFA Code of Conduct.

We expect management teams to strive toward developing a **settled and stable squad**, promoting **positive relationships** and fostering an environment that **encourages opportunities to witness**.

New Team Application Process

To join the ECFA, prospective teams must meet the following criteria:

1. Application Submitted with letter from the current minister of the church, and agreed support model.
2. **Initial Meeting with ECFA Leadership**

All managers must meet with the ECFA Chairman or a designated representative prior to acceptance. This meeting will focus on the ethos and purpose of the team, ensuring alignment with the league's values and structure.

0 Following the meeting, the Chairman may recommend to the league that the application be declined if the team is not a suitable fit.

2. **Code of Conduct Agreement**

All teams must formally agree to uphold and promote behaviours as outlined in the **ECFA Code of Conduct**.

3. **Church Connection Confirmation**

A letter of confirmation and support must be submitted from the church with which the team is connected, affirming the relationship and backing the application.

4. **Membership Vote**

The application will be subject to a **vote by existing member teams**.

- 0 Current members are encouraged to share any relevant experiences or knowledge of the applying team or its management.
- 0 A **simple majority vote** is required for the application to be approved.

League Registration & Criteria (Existing Member Clubs)

The Edinburgh Churches Football Association (ECFA) is a church-led, Christian football league that strives to provide a competitive sporting environment grounded in Christian values.

We welcome players of all backgrounds, regardless of faith, but expect all individuals associated with clubs to be **respectful of our values** and to comply with the ECFA Code of Conduct.

We also expect management teams to work towards building a **settled squad**, nurturing **strong relationships**, and fostering an environment that encourages **opportunities to witness through sport**.

New Season Application Requirements

To be eligible for participation each season, teams must meet the following criteria:

1. **Church Support Confirmation**

All managers must submit a **letter of confirmation from their church**, affirming continued support for the team's participation in the upcoming season.

2. **Code of Conduct Agreement**

All teams are required to sign and agree to adhere to the standards of behaviour set out in the **ECFA Code of Conduct**, and to actively promote these values within their team.

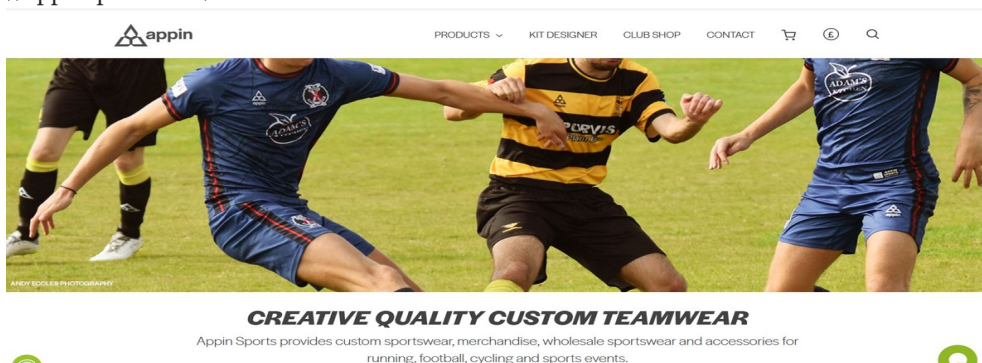
3. **Loss of Church Support**

Any team that no longer has active support from a church **may be required to reapply** as a new team. In some cases, the team's participation in the ECFA may be **refused** for the upcoming season.

21 - Current Sponsors

The league has two main sponsors - Appin Sports, who have sponsored the league for the 2026/27 Season, this is called the Appin ECFL (Edinburgh Churches Football Association) and also Kwik Fit, who have sponsored the ECFA Cup, previously the league cup, and now known as the ECFA Kwik Fit Cup

<https://appinsports.com/>





22 - Match Abandonment Policy

⚠ Scenario 1: Misconduct by a Team

If a match is **abandoned by the referee due to the behaviour of one team**, the following will apply:

- The offending team will forfeit the match 3-0.
- If the score at the time of abandonment is higher than 3-0 in favour of the opposition (e.g. 4-0 or 4-1), that score will stand.
- **Goal scorers** from both teams may be recorded.

Example: A match is abandoned at 4-1 due to misconduct. The result stands as 4-1, and all goal scorers are logged.

Scenario 2: Abandonment Due to Weather or Injury

If a match is **abandoned due to external factors** (e.g. **severe weather, serious injury, or other unavoidable incidents**):

- The match **will be rescheduled**.
- **Both managers** will be consulted in the rescheduling process.
- The point of abandonment may help determine whether a **full replay is viable**, especially considering **costs and logistics**.

Replay decisions will take into account how far into the match the abandonment occurred and whether the remaining game time justifies rescheduling.

23 - Squad Badges

See website.

24 - ECFA Transfers and Player Eligibility Policy

1. Player Transfers - ECFA to ECFA

- It is the responsibility of each team manager to confirm that any incoming player has not previously played for more than one ECFA team in the current season.

- If a player has already played for another ECFA team, the manager must **contact the previous manager** to confirm that the transfer is acceptable.
- A **Player Transfer Form** must be completed for all transfers between ECFA teams. Managers should request this form at the time of the player's move.
- All transfers where a player has played for an ECFA team before, will be posted into the ECFA WhatsApp channel.

2. Player Transfers - Amateur to ECFA

- Players currently registered and playing **Saturday amateur football** are **not eligible** to participate in the ECFA league. Players may be asked for proof that they are no longer registered to a team (email from Comet received by player)
- If an amateur player becomes unattached and wishes to join an ECFA team, the Player Transfer Form must include:
 - o The name of their previous club.
 - o The date they left that club.
 - o Any current suspensions or bans from other leagues, including the reason for the ban.
 - The league must be informed of any such circumstances.
 - Has the player played for your team already this season (If so the league will need details and can veto this move)

3. Junior, Semi-Professional, and Professional Players

- Players who are currently registered with **junior, semi-professional, or professional teams** are not eligible to play in the ECFA concurrently.
- If such a player leaves their club and wishes to join an ECFA team in the same season:
- The manager must receive an email from the player received via comet to confirm they have been released.
- A **Player Transfer Form** must be submitted.
 - o The league will assess the transfer and discuss it directly with the team manager, and may seek further proof that the player is no longer registered.

4. Transfer Restrictions - April 1st Deadline and Cup Semi Finals and Finals

- **From April 1st onwards, teams may not register new players for:**
 - o Cup matches, and
 - o Any **identified key league fixtures** (as determined by the league).

- Players may still be registered after April 1st if they do not fall under any of the restrictions mentioned in sections 1-3.
- Such players will be **ineligible** for both cup matches and key league fixtures after this date.
- Due to the ECFA Knockout Cup Final and Semi Finals taking place in the first half of the season, this rule has also been extended to the semi finals and final of this competition, any new additions added after the quarter final stage, will be ineligible to play in the semi final, and final of this competition. Any team that plays players registered after this point will forfeit the tie and the opposition

5. Cup Tie Rule

- The **Cup Tie Rule has been removed** due to changes surrounding post-April 1st transfers.
- However, to be eligible for Cup matches, players **must be registered on the official squad list by April 1st**.

6. Administrative Guidelines and Housekeeping

- The ECFA operates on a **trust-based system**, minimising the need for extensive paperwork and matchday administration.
- Team managers are expected to maintain integrity and communicate openly, especially regarding player transfers.
- If unsure about any player's eligibility, managers should **contact the league or reach out via the official WhatsApp group**.
- **Transfer forms will be shared in the managers' WhatsApp group** to maintain transparency across all teams.
- Any team found to have violated these rules-with sufficient evidence that a player was brought in to unfairly influence a game-will forfeit the match in question.

A player cannot play for more than two ECFA teams per season. In exceptional circumstances, a special request can be submitted to the league for approval if a player has already transferred twice or appeared for two separate teams.

25 - ECFA Squad Rules (2026/27 Season)

Matchday Squad Sizes

- Teams may bring a **maximum of 18 players** to a match.
- **Only 5 substitutions** may be made during a game.
- If you bring more than 16 players, it is your responsibility to **communicate clearly** to the squad that not all players are guaranteed playing time.

Substitutions

- **Default Rule:** Once a player is substituted off, they **cannot return** to the game.
- **Rolling Subs:** Permitted **only if agreed** by both teams **prior to kick-off** and communicated to the **referee**.
- **Injury Exception:** If a player is injured and leaves the team with 10 men, a previously substituted player **may re-enter** the match to replace the injured player.

Trialist Rule (Removed 27/08/2025)

There may be occasions where additional players are needed mid-season or new players express interest in joining. Please adhere to the following rules regarding trialists:

- A player may appear as a **trialist in up to 3 matches** per season. After that, they must be registered to continue playing.

Registration Deadline: All players must be registered by **Thursday** before a match, and 24 hours before a midweek match. Failure to do so will result in:

- A **3-0 forfeit** if the offending team won the match.
- A **1-point deduction** (with the result standing) if the offending team lost.
- **Notification Requirements:**
 - The **opposition** must be informed when trialists are fielded.
 - **The league must be notified with the following details:**
 - Full Name
 - Date the player was fielded as a trialist
 - Whether they have played for an ECFA team before
 - Confirmation of eligibility
 - **When registering a new player permanently, also include:**
 - Whether the player is **first-aid trained**
 - A **maximum of 3 trialists** is allowed in any matchday squad.
 - **Trialists may not play in:**
 - **Cup matches**
 - **Any match on or after April 1st each season.**
 - Please **inform the league** when a player is permanently **removed from your squad**.

⚠ **Note:** The ECFA encourages the development of **settled squads**. Excessive use of trialists may result in review or action by the League Admin.